

Evacuation Transportation Plan

Arrange a safe way to leave, a backup if that way fails, and the help each person, animal, and essential device will need.

! WARNING — URGENT ACTION

Leave when officials direct you to leave. Follow current evacuation routes and traffic control. Do not delay departure to finish this worksheet, gather belongings, or wait for a preferred ride.

IF USING A VEHICLE

- ☐ **Maintain it:** follow the manufacturer's routine service schedule; check tires, lights, brakes, fluids, battery, and required safety equipment.
- ☐ **Keep it usable:** maintain enough fuel or battery charge to leave the affected area, accounting for detours and congestion. Know a safe backup fueling or charging option.
- ☐ **Keep access ready:** place keys where authorized drivers can find them, and keep any gate, garage, or charging instructions with the plan.
- ☐ **Load safely:** use a seat and restraint for every person. Secure mobility equipment, carriers, supplies, and other cargo so they cannot move or block the driver's view, controls, or exits. Stay within vehicle and restraint limits.
- ☐ **Carry navigation:** keep current paper maps in case cellular service or navigation fails. Mark more than one route, but use the route officials direct during an evacuation.
- ☐ **Carry emergency supplies:** include water, essential medicines, first aid, phone charging, a flashlight, weather-appropriate clothing, and vehicle emergency items appropriate to local conditions.
- ☐ **Be ready early:** load essential items and position the vehicle before roads become congested—without blocking a road, sidewalk, fire lane, or hydrant.

Driver/contact name: _____ **Phone:** _____

Backup driver/contact: _____ **Phone:** _____

Vehicle make/model/color: _____

License plate: _____ **Usual location of keys:** _____

Fuel/charging plan: _____

Evacuation Transportation Plan — continued

IF NOT DRIVING

EVS-005

- ☐ Ask at least two household members, neighbors, friends, or caregivers whether they can provide a ride. Confirm what would cause them to come or call.
- ☐ Identify regular public transit and paratransit options. Learn eligibility, advance-reservation rules, operating hours, fare, service-area, companion, mobility-device, and animal policies before an emergency.
- ☐ Learn whether local officials provide evacuation transportation or an assistance registry. Registration may not guarantee a ride; keep another method.
- ☐ Tell the provider about an accessible pickup location and any boarding help, lift or ramp, securement position, mobility-equipment space, communication support, personal assistant, service animal, pet carrier, or other capacity needed.
- ☐ Keep the pickup address and entrance precise. Arrange a safe way to reach the pickup point; do not wait outdoors in hazardous conditions.

+ LOCAL INFORMATION — VERIFY BEFORE APPROVAL

Jurisdiction-specific transportation — VERIFY BEFORE USE OR PUBLICATION

Public transit provider / route: [VERIFY provider, service area, operating status, and official source]

Official phone: [VERIFY] **Website:** [VERIFY]

Paratransit provider: [VERIFY provider, eligibility, reservation process, and emergency policy]

Official phone: [VERIFY] **Website:** [VERIFY]

Evacuation assistance program or registry: [VERIFY agency, eligibility, enrollment, and limitations]

Official phone: [VERIFY] **Website:** [VERIFY]

Official evacuation pickup site(s): [VERIFY locations and when officials activate them]

Verified directly with responsible agency by: _____ **Date:** _____

Evacuation Transportation Plan — continued

BACKUP PLAN

Choose two contacts or methods that do not depend on the same person, vehicle, provider, or communication channel.

Method/contact 1: _____ Phone: _____

Vehicle/provider and capacity: _____

Method/contact 2: _____ Phone: _____

Vehicle/provider and capacity: _____

Primary meeting/pickup point: _____

Backup meeting/pickup point: _____

Trigger to request help early: When _____

I will contact: _____ by this method: _____

△ CAUTION — PREVENT HARM

Request help before conditions worsen. Use the trigger above when transport may take time—for example, when an official warning is issued, a likely hazard is approaching, a driver becomes unavailable, or accessible transportation may be limited. Do not wait for immediate danger.

CAPACITY AND ACCESS CHECK

Pickup location and accessible entrance: _____

Boarding, transfer, lift, ramp, or communication help: _____

Mobility equipment and space required: _____

Equipment dimensions/weight or securement note: _____

Animal capacity needed (number, species, carrier/restraint): _____

Passenger count: _____ Seat/restraint needs: _____

Evacuation Transportation Plan — continued

- 1 **Check** current instructions from public officials before moving, if it is safe to do so.
- 2 **Follow** official routes, signs, checkpoints, lane controls, and directions from emergency personnel. Do not take a familiar shortcut when officials direct another route.
- 3 **Keep** roads, shoulders, intersections, gates, and access points clear for responders and other evacuees. Stop or park only in a safe, permitted place.
- 4 **Turn around** rather than drive through floodwater or a closed, damaged, blocked, burning, smoke-obscured, or otherwise unsafe road. Never move a barricade.
- 5 **Avoid exposing** anyone to smoke, floodwater, fire, downed wires, debris, hazardous materials, or another danger while walking, waiting, loading, transferring, refueling, or charging. Change plans and request help from a safe location.
- 6 **Tell** the household contact when the group departs and, when safe, when it arrives. Continue monitoring official information because routes and destinations can change.

× DANGER — STOP NOW

Do not enter floodwater. Water can hide a washed-out road and can move a vehicle. Turn around, obey closures, and use an official alternate route.

VERIFY AND CONNECT THIS PLAN

- ☐ Both transportation methods agreed to the plan and know the pickup points.
- ☐ The vehicle or provider can carry every passenger, mobility device, essential item, and animal safely.
- ☐ Routes, contact details, provider rules, and pickup accessibility were checked.
- ☐ This plan is stored with paper maps and the household's evacuation materials.

Last verification date: _____ **Verified with/by:** _____

Use related handouts instead of duplicating their worksheets: EVS-004 for evacuation routes and destinations; EVS-006 for children and animals; EVS-007 for shelter-in-place planning; and EVS-010 for accessible evacuation planning.

SOURCES

Sources: Ready.gov, “Evacuation” and “Individuals with Disabilities” (accessed 2026-09-25); National Highway Traffic Safety Administration, “Vehicle Safety” (accessed 2026-09-25); National Weather Service, “Turn Around Don't Drown” (accessed 2026-09-25).

<https://www.ready.gov/evacuation>

<https://www.ready.gov/disability>

<https://www.nhtsa.gov/vehicle-safety>

<https://www.weather.gov/safety/flood-turn-around-dont-drown>